Deploying with a ServiceNow Update Set

How to export the Project Update Set and move it to another instance

1. What is an Update Set?

An **Update Set** is a package in ServiceNow that records all the configuration changes you made (tables, forms, business rules, flows, UI policies and so on). Instead of rebuilding everything by hand, you export this package as an **XML file** and load it into the target instance. This is how the developed solution is **deployed** from the development instance to another instance.

2. Export steps

Step	Action	Why
1	Go to **All menus** and search for **Local Update Sets**.	Opens the list of update sets on this instance.
2	Under **System Update Sets**, select **Local Update Sets**.	Shows update sets created locally.
3	Open the **Project Update Set**.	This set holds all the project changes.
4	Change **State** from **In progress** to **Complete**.	Marks the work as finished, so no new changes get captured.
5	Click **Save** on the form.	Stores the new state.
6	Under **Related Links**, click **Export to XML**.	Generates the export file.
7	The update set downloads to your system as an **XML file**.	This file is the deployable package.
8	Share the XML file through WhatsApp or Mail.	Lets others receive the package.

3. Importing on the other instance

The person receiving the file can load it like this:

- Go to **All menus** → **Retrieved Update Sets**.
- Click **Import Update Set from XML**, choose the XML file and upload it.
- Open the imported update set and click **Preview Update Set**. Resolve any conflicts or errors shown.
- Click **Commit Update Set** to apply the changes to the instance.
- Test the main features to confirm the deployment worked.

4. Why the state must be Complete

- While the state is **In progress**, new changes can still get added to the set.
- Setting it to **Complete** freezes the package, so the exported version is final and consistent.

5. Good practices

- Give the update set a clear name and description (for example, project name and version).
- Keep one update set per project or feature, so the export stays clean.
- Keep a copy of the XML file as a backup and version record.
- Preview before committing, and fix any missing dependencies first.
- Sharing by Mail is preferable for official use; WhatsApp is fine for quick sharing, but keep the original file safe.
- Include these steps in your deployment guide, as part of the project documentation.

Summary: Complete the Project Update Set, export it as XML, share the file, and the receiving instance imports, previews and commits it. That is how the solution moves to another environment.